NANYANG TECHNOLOGICAL UNIVERSITY SINGAPORE

DA2002 Submission
Final Project

Instructor: Mr Jaxton Su



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Acknowledgement

I would like to express my deepest gratitude to Mr. Jaxton Su for his unwavering dedication, invaluable guidance, and endless patience throughout the duration of this course. His expertise and support have been instrumental in bringing my vision to life, and for that, I am eternally grateful.

Additionally, I would like to acknowledge the significance of this module in fostering an environment that encourages creativity and injects a sense of enjoyment into the rigorous curriculum. This unique blend of challenge and creativity has not only motivated me but also significantly contributed to my personal and artistic development. Thank you for providing such an enriching and inspiring experience.

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Project overview

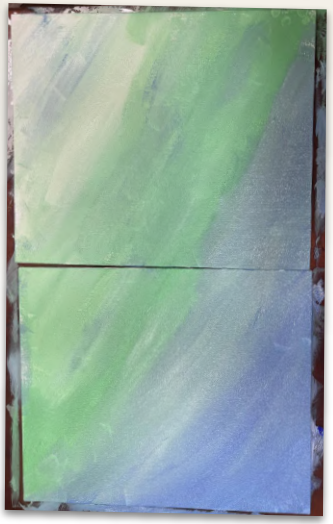
The theme I selected for this project is "Journey of Life," using the metaphor of a Jellyfish. It was challenging to settle on a topic initially, as I first thought to depict life's journey across three different environments (sea, land, sky). However, after receiving feedback on the first painting of the Jellyfish, I was inspired to craft the narratives for the remainder of my final project

Developmental Paintings



Developmental Paintings

1 **Innocence and Hope:** Progression

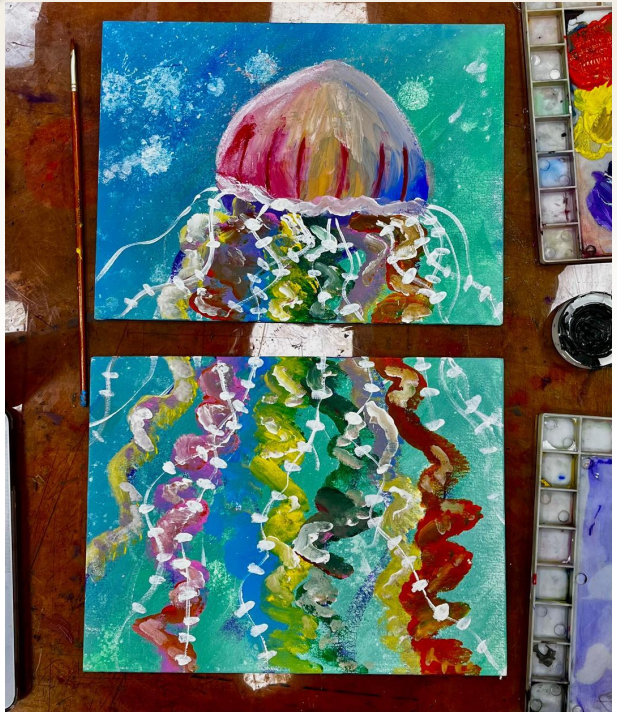





Developmental Paintings

1

Innocence and Hope: Final painting



For this painting, I wanted to show a soft, gentle feel by using light pastel colors and smooth textures.

The calm colors of the jellyfish stand out against the busier background, creating a sense of calm hopefulness.

I painted the jellyfish with soft lines to make it look like it's peacefully moving through the water, even though the colors around it are more wild and active.

My goal was to capture the feeling of being hopeful and pure in a world that's full of energy and change.

Developmental Paintings

2 **Adversity & Resilience:** Progression

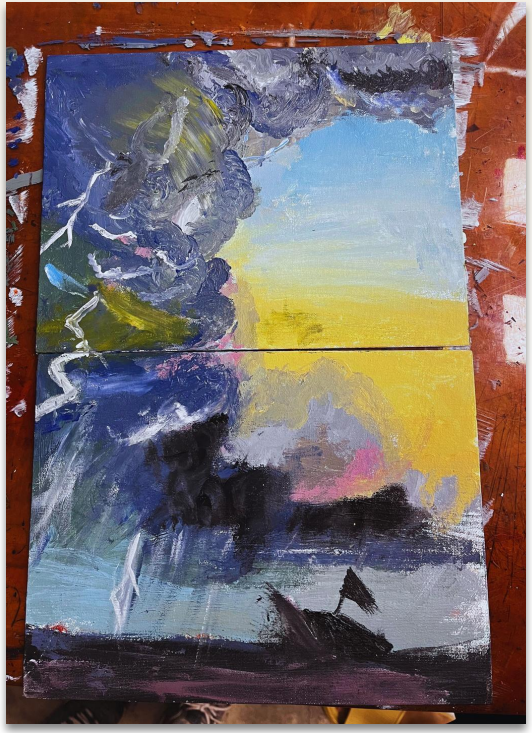






Developmental Paintings

2 Adversity & Resilience Final painting



In this painting, I used dark, bold colors for the storm to represent life's challenges, with a small, determined boat symbolizing our resilience.

My aim was to invoke the principle of scale to emphasize the boat's bravery against the vastness of nature, underscoring our capacity to endure and push through adversity.

Yet, following Presentation Day, I realized the need to weave in the image of the Jellyfish to create a cohesive thread linking all four of my paintings.

Developmental Paintings

3

Transformation & Burden: Progression







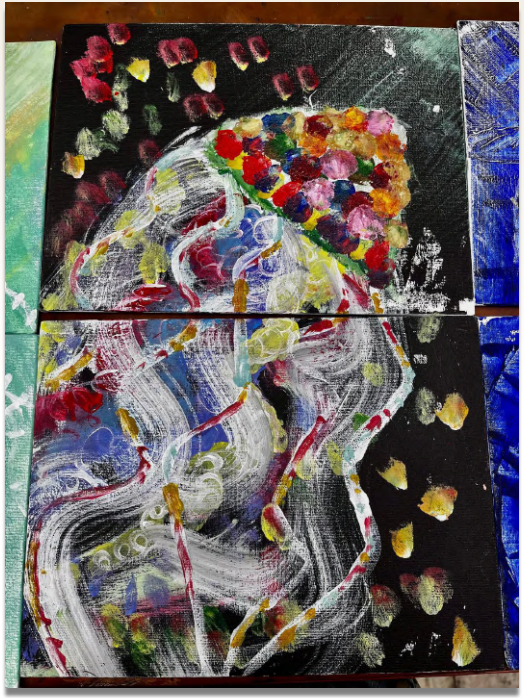




Developmental Paintings

3

Transformation & Burden: Final Painting



In painting this, my aim was to highlight the interplay of contrast and color to represent life's burdens and transformation.

The dark background and the jellyfish's bright colors contrast to symbolize struggles and growth.

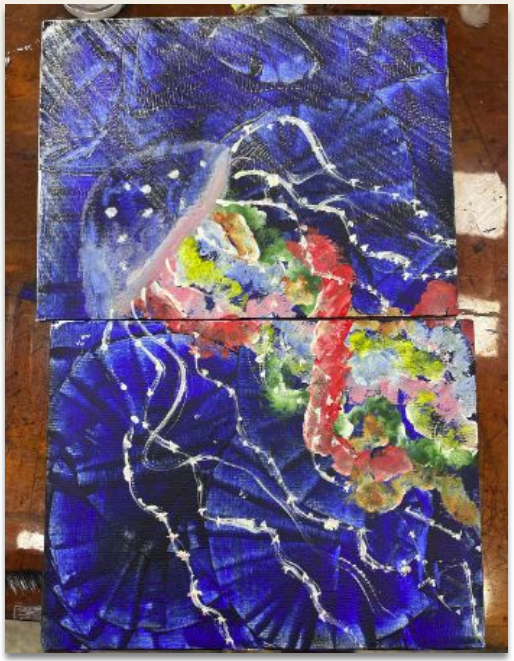
The upward movement in the composition contrasts with the heavy backdrop, showing that we rise against life's challenges

Developmental Paintings

4

Renewal & Wisdom: Progression

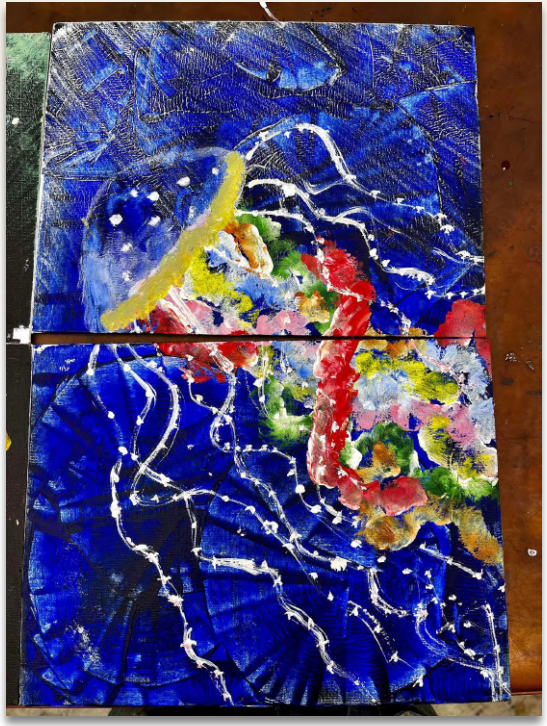




Developmental Paintings

4

Renewal & Wisdom: Final Painting



In crafting this piece, my focus was on utilizing the principles of harmony and unity through color to encapsulate the themes of renewal and wisdom.

I selected a dominant blue palette, invoking a sense of calm and depth, to set the stage for a story of rebirth

Presentation Day

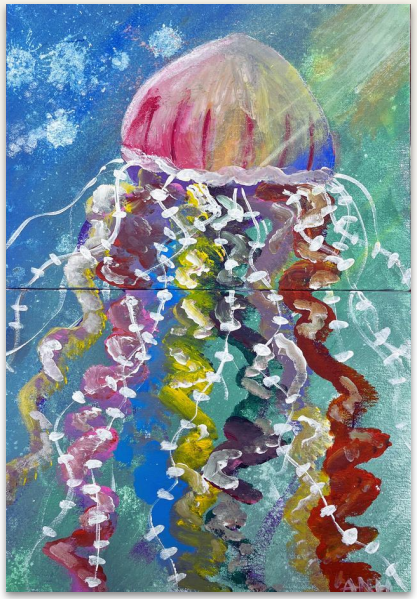


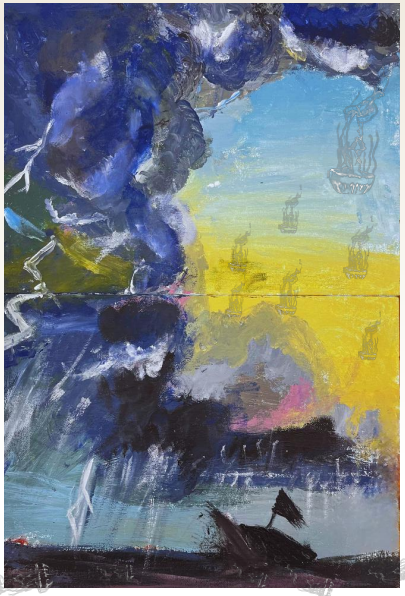


Following Presentation Day, I took instructor and friend's feedback and refined my project. On the next slide, I am pleased to present the four finalized paintings

Completed Artworks

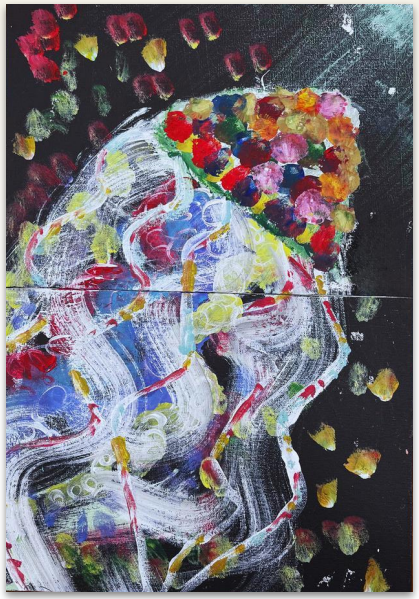
Innocence & Hope

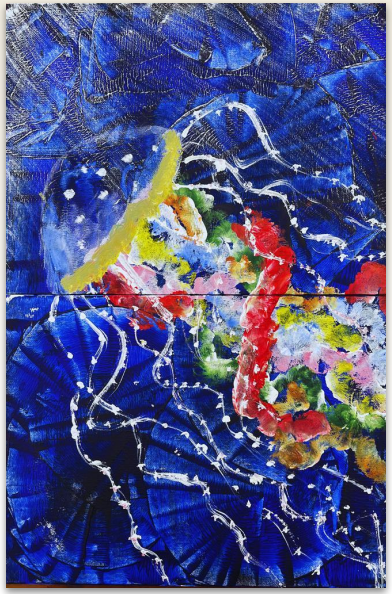




Adversity & Resilience

Adversity & Resilience





Renewal & Wisdom

Short Write-up

**“There is something beautiful about all scars of whatever nature.
A scar means the hurt is over, the wound is closed and healed, done with.” – Harry Crews**

The story unfolds through four captivating paintings, each marking a distinct chapter in the life journey of a serene jellyfish. The first painting portrays the jellyfish in its purest form, gracefully gliding towards the light, its colors bright and full of hope. This symbolizes life's innocent beginnings, untouched by the world's harshness. The narrative shifts dramatically in the second painting. Amid a fierce storm, a small boat struggles against overwhelming odds, embodying the resilience of the human spirit. A faint light piercing through the darkness reminds us that hope persists even in our bleakest moments. In the third painting, our jellyfish, set against a stark black backdrop, is marked with vibrant circles and a spectrum of colors. These new elements, beautiful yet burdensome, signify the scars of adversity, challenging the creature's pursuit of light. The final painting offers a resolution. The jellyfish, altered yet essentially unchanged, exhibits colors that hint at healing and renewal. Its intertwined tails suggest a learned caution, a protective armor from life's battles. This scene captures the essence of resilience: emerging from darkness not as we once were, but wiser and stronger, forever capable of finding beauty in our scars.

Thank you

